Star and Moon

A Novella in Two Timelines

Set in the Harry Potter universe

Cassiopeia Black × Remus Lupin

Marauders Era (1975–1981) · OG Timeline (1995–1998)

The house of Black does not weep.
The house of Black endures.

A novella in two timelines

Harry Potter universe — canon-compliant except for one divergence:

Cassiopeia "Cassie" Black, younger sister of Sirius and Regulus Black (in canon, Sirius and Regulus are Orion and Walburga's only children; Cassie is the singular exception).

Ship: Cassie Black × Remus Lupin

Timelines: - **Marauders Era:** 1976–1981 (Hogwarts, the First Wizarding War) - **OG Timeline:** 1995–1998 (Harry's fifth year through the Battle of Hogwarts)

> The house of Black is ancient and noble. It is also a house of graves. > Sirius went to Azkaban. Regulus went to the cave. Cassie went to war. > Remus Lupin loved Tonks. Cassie Black loved him first. And she endured.

Prologue

Grimmauld Place, July 1995

OG Timeline

Number twelve, Grimmauld Place smelled of damp and old hatred. The Black family home had stood for centuries, a monument to pure-blood pride, and Cassie moved through its halls like a ghost in her own childhood. The house had been empty for years, ever since Sirius ran away at sixteen, ever since Regulus died, ever since their parents passed. Now it stood as the headquarters of the reformed Order of the Phoenix, and Cassie — the last Black — walked its corridors with her wand in her pocket and her heart in her throat.

"Cassie."

She turned. Remus Lupin stood in the doorway of the drawing room, his robes threadbare, his face lined with grief and fatigue. He looked older than thirty-five should allow. His hair was greying at the temples, and there was a new scar along his jawline that she did not recognize. He was wearing his wedding band — a simple gold band, new within the last year.

"Remus," she said.

He crossed the room to her, and for a moment she thought he would embrace her. Instead, he stopped just short, his hands opening and closing at his sides. "You came."

"I said I would."

"The others are in the kitchen. Molly, Arthur, Kingsley. Harry's upstairs — he had a nightmare. Again."

Cassie nodded. She had read about Harry's nightmares in the *Daily Prophet* — or rather, she had read the Ministry's denial of them, and then *The Quibbler*'s lurid confirmation, and then Dumbledore's quiet confirmation, and then the *Prophet*'s retraction. The truth was somewhere in between, as it always was. Harry Potter was fifteen, and he was fighting a war that had begun before he was born.

"I'm sorry about Sirius," Remus said quietly.

Cassie's chest tightened. "Thank you."

They stood in the hall, two survivors in a house of the dead, and Cassie remembered the boy Remus had been — the prefect with the tired eyes and the scars, the Marauder who had laughed in the Gryffindor common room and vanished once a month to the Shrieking Shack. She remembered loving him. She remembered him loving her, once, before the war took everything and Tonks gave him something she could not.

"Dumbledore wants to speak with you," Remus said. "About your connections. About what you know of the old Death Eater networks. Your family —"

"My family is dead or in prison," Cassie said sharply. "Regulus is dead. Sirius is a fugitive. Mother and Father are dead. I am the last Black, Remus. And I have nothing to give you but my hatred of Voldemort and my willingness to fight."

Remus flinched at the name. Cassie did not. She had stopped flinching years ago.

"I didn't mean it like that," Remus said. "I meant — you understand them. You understand the pure-blood mindset. You know how they recruit, how they think—"

"I know how they hurt people," Cassie said. "That's what I know."

Remus reached out, then stopped himself. His hand hovered between them, trembling slightly, and Cassie saw the war in his eyes — the love he still carried, the duty he owed to Tonks, the old conviction that he was too broken to touch anyone.

"Cassie," he said.

"Remus," she said back.

She stepped forward. She closed the distance between them. She laid her hand on his cheek, her thumb brushing the new scar, and Remus closed his eyes as though she had struck him.

"You're still afraid of me," she whispered.

"I'm afraid of losing you," he said. "I'm afraid of the moon. I'm afraid of everything. But I am married to Tonks, Cassie. I have a son on the way. I cannot—"

"I know," Cassie said, and her hand fell away. "You belong to her now. You belonged to me once, but that was a lifetime ago."

Remus opened his eyes. They were grey, stormy, full of years and pain.

"Dumbledore is waiting," he said.

"Let him wait," Cassie said. But she did not move back. Not yet.

And for the first time in fifteen years, the house of Black felt like something other than a tomb — and something other than a home.

Chapter One

The Same Year

Marauders Era, Hogwarts, September 1976

The Great Hall floated above Cassie like an enchanted sky, thousands of candles drifting in the blackness, and she felt very small and very exposed. It was her fifth year. She was fifteen. She was a Black, sorted into Gryffindor four years ago over her mother's strenuous objections, and she was the only Black in Gryffindor history who had not been disowned — yet.

She slid onto the Gryffindor bench beside her brother Sirius, who was entering his sixth year and who threw an arm around her shoulders and beamed. "My sister! Still a lion! I was beginning to think Mother had finally beaten the courage out of you."

"Don't get used to it," Cassie said, but she leaned into him.

Sirius was radiant — laughing grey eyes, messy dark hair, the effortless charisma that had made him the heart of Gryffindor house since first year. He was also, Cassie knew, on the verge of explosion. His letters home had gone unanswered. His mother's howlers had grown louder. He was living on borrowed time in that house, and they both knew it.

Across the table, at the end of the bench, sat Remus Lupin. He was wearing his prefect badge, silver against the grey wool, and he looked tired — the particular, bone-deep tiredness that came from spending one night a month as a monster and the rest of the year pretending to be a boy. His robes were a little too big, as though he were trying to shrink into them. His hair was already greying at the temples, though he was only sixteen.

He looked up as Cassie sat down. Their eyes met. Something quiet and seismic shifted.

"Cassie," Remus said, nodding.

"Remus," she said back.

Sirius, oblivious as ever, launched into a story about a prank he was planning with James and Peter. Cassie half-listened, her attention fixed on Remus. He did not smile. He did not look away. He simply watched her, and she watched him, and in the noise of the Great Hall they heard each other perfectly.

He's a Marauder, Cassie thought. *He's a prefect. He's a werewolf. He's mine, if I can have him.*

She's a Black, Remus thought. *She's Sirius's sister. She's Regulus's sister. She's Gryffindor when she should be Slytherin. She's brave, and she's kind, and she will end up hurt if she loves me.*

The sorting continued. New first-years were called forward. The Hat sang its song. Cassie Black, fifteen years old, in love with a boy who believed he was unlovable, thought: *This is how it begins.*

Chapter Two

The Veil

OG Timeline, Department of Mysteries, June 1996

The archway stood in the Death Chamber, a stone frame draped with a tattered veil that fluttered in a wind that did not exist. Beyond it, Cassie heard voices — whispers, laughter, the murmur of the dead. She had read about the veil in old Black family texts, in forbidden volumes hidden behind false panels in the library at Grimmauld Place. The veil was a border. Between life and death. Between this world and the next.

Sirius had fallen through it.

Cassie stood at the edge of the dais, her wand gripped so tightly her fingers ached. The battle raged around her — spells flying, Death Eaters falling, members of the Order dueling in the shadows — but Cassie could not look away from the archway. She had come to rescue Harry, to help the Order, to fight. But now all she could think was: *Sirius is gone. My brother is gone. And there is nothing I can do.*

"Cassie!"

Remus appeared at her side, his face streaked with soot and blood. He grabbed her arm, pulling her back from the edge. "Don't," he said. "Don't go near it."

"I have to—"

"There's nothing to save," Remus said, and his voice broke. "Cassie, he's gone."

"No," Cassie said. She twisted in his grip. "No, he can't be. He just—he fell. He's on the other side. We can—"

"Cassie." Remus turned her to face him. His eyes were grey and stormy and full of a grief she recognized from her own chest. "Sirius is dead."

The words landed like a blow. Cassie's knees buckled. Remus caught her, his arms wrapping around her, and she fell against him, her forehead pressing to his shoulder. She smelled of old books and wet fur and something clean, something that was just Remus, and she wept.

She wept for Sirius, reckless and brilliant and gone. She wept for Regulus, dead these seventeen years in a cave with a locket around his neck. She wept for her mother and father, for the house of Black reduced to a single girl in a war she had not chosen. She wept for the girl she had been, who had believed she could love Remus Lupin and still survive.

Remus held her. He did not say *it's all right*, because it was not all right. He did not say *he's in a better place*, because he did not believe in better places. He simply held her, his hand at the back of her head, his cheek pressed to her hair, and let her break.

When the tears slowed, Cassie pulled back. Her face was wet, her eyes swollen, but the panic had receded, replaced by a cold, hard determination.

"He died fighting," she said. "Sirius died fighting. And so will I."

Remus looked at her, his expression softening into something fierce and proud. "I know you will."

"The veil," Cassie said, nodding toward the archway. "The whispers. My mother used to say the Blacks could hear their ancestors in the walls. I never believed her."

"Maybe she was right," Remus said. "But Cassie — listen to me. The dead stay dead. Sirius would want you to live. Not to join him. Live."

Cassie looked at the veil one last time. The voices murmured, indistinct, and for a moment she thought she heard Sirius's laugh — loud, reckless, full of life. Then it was gone, and the veil was just a veil, and the chamber was just a room full of death.

"All right," Cassie said. "I'll live. For him."

Remus took her hand. "Come on," he said. "Harry needs us. The battle isn't over."

They ran back into the fight, Cassie Black and Remus Lupin, two soldiers in a war that had spanned two generations, and Cassie thought, not for the first time, that love was not a soft thing. Love was choosing to stay, even when the world was ending. Love was holding someone's hand as you walked back into the fire. And love, sometimes, was letting go.

Chapter Three

The Mark

Marauders Era, Hogwarts, Easter 1977

The sixth-year Gryffindor dormitory was quiet except for the crackling fire and the soft snoring of Peter Pettigrew in the next bed. Cassie sat on the edge of her bed, wrapped in her robes, staring at the letter in her hands.

It was from Regulus. He had not written in months. He had not come home for Christmas. He had joined the Death Eaters, or so the rumours said — rumours that Cassie's mother greeted with pride and Cassie's father with silence. Sirius had not spoken to Regulus since the sorting. Cassie had not spoken to him since he left Hogwarts.

The letter was short. *I cannot undo what I have done. Do not look for me. Do not tell Mother.*

Cassie's hands shook. She knew what Regulus had done. She knew, because she had seen him in the corridor outside the Slytherin common room, talking to a boy with a pale face and a dark mark on his forearm. She knew, because she was a Black, and Blacks noticed things.

There was a knock at the door.

Cassie stuffed the letter under her pillow. "Come in."

Remus Lupin opened the door. He was not on prefect duty. He was wearing his robes over his pyjamas, and he looked worse than usual — pale, shadowed, his robes hanging off him.

"I couldn't sleep," he said.

"Neither could I," Cassie said. "Remus, what's happening to Regulus?"

Remus closed the door behind him. He crossed the room and sat on the edge of Cassie's bed, leaving a careful space between them. "I don't know for certain."

"You know more than you're saying."

Remus looked at her. "I know that James and Sirius have been watching the Slytherin table. I know that Dumbledore has been asking questions. I know that the Dark Mark is appearing over more and more villages, and that the Ministry is lying about how many of them there are."

"And Regulus?"

Remus was silent for a long moment. Then he said, "Your brother is a good boy, Cassie. He's always been the obedient one. The one who wants to make your parents proud. And that's exactly what makes him dangerous."

Cassie's breath caught. "You think he's taken the Mark."

"I think he's considering it," Remus said. "And I think that if he does, there will be no coming back."

Cassie reached out, her fingers brushing Remus's hand. His skin was warm beneath the wool, and he trembled slightly.

"I can't lose both of them," she whispered. "Sirius is already gone — Mother has disowned him, he's living with the Potters, he won't speak to us. And Regulus—"

"If he takes the Mark," Remus said softly, "he'll be gone too. In a different way."

Cassie turned her hand beneath his, lacing their fingers together. Remus's breath hitched, barely audible.

"We're not supposed to do this," Remus said. "I'm a prefect. You're a fifth-year. I'm a werewolf. You're a Black."

"We're two people who care about each other," Cassie said. "That's all."

Remus did not pull away. He looked at Cassie, and in her eyes he saw everything he could not have — safety, belonging, a future. And he saw, too, the war gathering beyond the castle walls, and he knew that he could not offer her any of it.

"Cassie," he said.

"I know," she said. "You can't. I know."

She squeezed his hand once, then let go. "Go back to your dormitory, prefect. I'll be fine."

Remus did not move. He watched her, his expression caught between longing and terror, and Cassie understood, with a sudden clarity that frightened her, that loving Remus Lupin meant loving a man who believed he was unlovable. It meant standing beside him when the moon turned him into a monster. It meant choosing, again and again, to stay — even when he chose to walk away.

She turned back to her bed. Behind her, she heard Remus's footsteps retreat, slow and reluctant, down the spiral stairs.

Cassie Black touched her lips, where the ghost of his kiss still lingered, and whispered into the dark, "I'm not afraid of you."

The dormitory said nothing. The fire crackled. And somewhere, in the dark, Regulus Black was choosing a side — and it was not hers.

Chapter Four

The Wedding

OG Timeline, The Burrow, August 1997

The Burrow was crowded and loud and full of love, and Cassie stood at the edge of the garden, watching Bill Weasley and Fleur Delacour dance under the marquee lights. It was August 1, 1997. The Ministry had fallen three days ago. Scrimgeour was dead. The Death Eaters were everywhere. And everyone was pretending, for one evening, that the world was not ending.

Cassie was not pretending. She wore a black dress — the house of Black did not wear bright colours to weddings, even when they were invited — and she held a glass of champagne she had no intention of drinking. She was here because Remus had asked her to be here. Because she was part of the Order now. Because she was the last Black, and the Order needed every wand it could get.

"Cassie."

She turned. Remus Lupin stood beside her, his robes formal but worn, his hair greyer than she remembered. He was wearing his wedding band — plain gold, new within the last year. He looked tired. He always looked tired. But there was a softness around his eyes that had not been there in 1977, a softness that belonged to Nymphadora Tonks.

"Remus," she said.

"Teddy's with Molly," Remus said. "Tonks is — she's helping Fleur with something. She'll be here soon."

Cassie nodded. Teddy Lupin, born April 1998 — no, not yet, it was August 1997, Tonks was pregnant, the baby was due in the spring. Remus was going to be a father. He was married. He had a life that did not include Cassie.

"You look well," Remus said.

"So do you," Cassie said. "Married. Father-to-be. Order spy."

Remus managed a smile, small and sad. "You make it sound like a list of accomplishments."

"Isn't it?"

They stood in silence for a moment, the music from the marquee drifting over them. Cassie thought of Hogwarts, of Easter 1977, of Remus's hand in hers and the war that was coming. She thought of Sirius in Azkaban — no, Sirius was dead, Sirius had died in June, and Cassie had not yet fully forgiven the world for it.

"Sirius would have liked this," Cassie said. "The noise. The colours. The Weasleys."

"Sirius would have tried to set fire to the marquee," Remus said, and his smile widened slightly. "And James would have helped him."

Cassie laughed, and the sound felt strange in her chest — as though she had forgotten how. "Yes. They would have."

Remus looked at her, and Cassie saw the man he had become — scarred, weary, married, a father-to-be, a soldier in a war that had outlived its first generation. And she saw the boy he had been — the prefect with the tired eyes, the Marauder who had vanished once a month, the man who had once loved her and let her go.

"Cassie," Remus said.

"Yes?"

"Tonks loves me," he said quietly. "I love her. I want you to know that. I want you to know that I am not — that I did not—"

"I know," Cassie said. "You belong to her. You belonged to me once, but that was a lifetime ago. And I am the last Black, Remus. I do not get to keep things."

Remus reached out, then stopped himself. His hand hovered between them, trembling slightly. "I am sorry," he said.

"I know," Cassie said. "So am I."

She finished her champagne in one swallow and set the glass on a passing tray. "I should go," she said. "Harry and his friends — they're here somewhere. I should make sure they're all right."

"Cassie—"

"Remus," she said, and this time her voice was gentle. "Live. For Tonks. For Teddy. For Sirius. Live."

Remus nodded, his eyes shining with unshed tears. "You too," he said. "You live too, Cassie Black. You endure."

Cassie turned and walked into the crowd. She did not look back. She endured.

Chapter Five

The Cave

Marauders Era, A Cave Somewhere, 1979

The cave was cold and smelled of salt and magic. Cassie stood at the entrance, her wand raised, her heart hammering against her ribs. Behind her, three other members of the Order — Dedalus Digby, Emmeline Vance, and a young Auror named Frank Longbottom — waited with their wands ready. Ahead, in the darkness, was Regulus.

Regulus had not been seen in three weeks. He had written one letter, to Cassie alone, delivered by a barn owl that dropped dead on her windowsill. *I have done something terrible*, it said. *I cannot undo it. Do not look for me.*

Of course Cassie had looked for him.

She stepped into the cave. The walls glistened with moisture, and the air tasted of brine and old enchantments. Deeper inside, she found him.

Regulus Black stood by an underground lake, his face pale in the wandlight, a locket clutched in his hand. He looked younger than eighteen, smaller than he should, and when he turned to see Cassie, his eyes were full of tears.

"Cassie," he said. "You shouldn't have come."

"I'm not leaving without you," Cassie said.

"I can't leave." Regulus held up the locket. "This is one of his horcruxes, Cassie. I found it. I stole it. And I'm going to die here, because I drank the potion, and the inferi are coming, and—"

"They're not coming," Cassie said. She stepped forward, her wand steady. "We're here. The Order is here. We're taking you home."

Regulus shook his head. "You don't understand. He knows. The Dark Lord knows I betrayed him. He's coming for me, Cassie. He's coming for all of us. And when he finds me—"

"He won't find you," Cassie said. She reached out, her fingers closing around Regulus's wrist. "Because I'm your sister. And I love you. And I am not letting you die in a cave."

The sound of water breaking echoed through the cave. Inferi emerged from the lake, pale and grasping, their dead hands reaching for Regulus. Cassie raised her wand. "Incendio!"

Fire burst from her wand, bright and fierce, and the inferi shrieked and fell back. Remus — Remus, who had followed her, who had refused to let her go alone — stepped out of the shadows, his wand blazing, silver and fire and light.

"Cassie!" Remus shouted. "Get back!"

"Regulus!" Cassie yelled over the roar of flames. "Take my hand!"

Regulus hesitated. Then he let go of the locket — let it fall into the lake — and took Cassie's hand. Remus pulled them both back, spells firing, fire and light pushing back the dark, and they ran.

They escaped. Regulus lived — for a time. He would die months later, in another cave, with another potion, and Cassie would never forgive herself for not being there. But in this cave, in this moment, Cassie Black saved her brother, and Remus Lupin held her hand as they ran, and the war raged on around them, and love was a fire that refused to be extinguished.

Later, back at Grimmauld Place, Cassie sat on her bed and stared at the locket, now destroyed, its dark magic unraveled. Remus sat beside her, silent, his hand resting on hers.

"He's going to die," Cassie said. "Regulus. He's going to die, and I couldn't—"

"You saved him tonight," Remus said.

"Tonight isn't forever."

"No," Remus agreed. "But it's something. Cassie, look at me."

She did. His eyes were grey and kind and full of an aching tenderness.

"You're not responsible for everyone," he said. "You're responsible for yourself. For your choices. For the person you choose to be."

"And who am I choosing to be?" Cassie asked.

Remus smiled, small and sad. "Someone who loves her brother enough to walk into a cave of inferi. Someone who loves her friends enough to fight a war she didn't start. Someone who loved me, once. And someone who will endure."

Cassie turned her hand beneath his, lacing their fingers together. "Yes," she said. "I will endure."

Remus kissed her then — briefly, chastely, for the last time. It was not the kiss of lovers reunited. It was the kiss of two people who had loved each other and had to let go. When they parted, Cassie rested her forehead against his.

"The war isn't over," she whispered.

"I know," Remus said.

"But we are," Cassie said. "For now, we are."

And in the dark, with the cave behind them and the war ahead, Cassie Black and Remus Lupin said goodbye. Not because they stopped loving each other. But because the world was taking everything, and Remus belonged to Tonks now, and Cassie was the last Black, and the last Black endured.

Chapter Six

The Shack

OG Timeline, The Shrieking Shack, May 2, 1998

The battle for Hogwarts raged above them. Spells shook the floorboards of the Shrieking Shack, and dust rained from the ceiling in thick grey sheets. Cassie pressed herself against the wall, her wand ready, her breath coming in short, sharp gasps. Outside, the castle burned. Outside, her world was ending.

And in the corner, in the shadows, Remus Lupin was dying.

He lay on a cot — the same cot he had used as a student, when this shack was his monthly prison — and his breath rattled in his chest. Tonks was gone, killed by Bellatrix Lestrange in the courtyard. Teddy was an orphan, an hour old and already without parents. Remus knew it. He had known it since he saw Tonks fall.

Cassie knelt beside him. She had taken his hand, and she would not let go. Her fingers were intertwined with his, her thumb brushing his knuckles, and Remus looked up at her with eyes that were grey and clear and full of love.

"Cassie," he whispered.

"I'm here," she said. "I'm here, Remus. I'm not leaving."

"You should go," Remus said. "The battle—"

"The battle can wait," Cassie said fiercely. "You're not dying alone. I won't let you."

Remus managed a smile, weak and broken. "You always were stubborn. A Black through and through."

"I'm not a Black anymore," Cassie said. "Not really. I'm Cassie. And I loved you."

Remus's eyes closed. His breathing grew shallower. Cassie felt the life slipping out of him, thread by thread, and she held him tighter, as though she could keep him here by force of will alone.

"Remember," Remus said, his voice fading. "The Astronomy Tower. The stars. You said—"

"I'm not afraid of you," Cassie finished, her voice breaking. "I'm not afraid of you, Remus. I never was."

Remus opened his eyes. He looked at Cassie, truly looked at her, and Cassie saw the boy from Hogwarts, the man from the veil, the werewolf who had spent his life believing he was unlovable. She saw him see her — Cassie Black, the sister of Sirius and Regulus, the Gryffindor lion, the woman who had loved him across two wars and had let him go.

"I love you, Cassie Black," Remus whispered.

"I know," she said. "I love you too. But you belong to Tonks. You belong to Teddy. And you will always belong to the Marauders."

Remus's eyes closed. His hand went limp in hers. His eyes stayed open, fixed on her, full of a peace she did not feel.

Cassie laid her forehead against his. She wept silently, her tears falling on his face, on his grey hair, on the scar along his jaw that she had traced so many times. The battle raged above them. The castle burned. The war would be won, eventually, but the cost was written in graves, and Remus Lupin was one of them.

When she finally rose, Cassie's face was dry and her eyes were hard. She wiped her tears on her sleeve, stood, and picked up her wand.

She walked out of the Shrieking Shack and into the battle. She fought for Sirius, who had fallen through the veil. She fought for Regulus, who had died in a cave. She fought for Remus, who had loved her and been loved in return. She fought for every Black who had ever endured, and for every person who had ever been told they were not enough.

And when the fighting was done, and Voldemort lay defeated, and the survivors counted their dead, Cassie Black stood in the Great Hall beside Harry Potter and the remnants of the Order, and she did not weep. She endured.

Because that was what the house of Black did. That was what Cassie did. And that was what love demanded — not that it save them, but that it outlast them.

Epilogue

The Stars Remain

OG Timeline, Hogwarts, September 1998

The new school year began beneath a sky full of stars. Cassie stood at the edge of the Astronomy Tower, the same tower where she had first loved Remus twenty-two years before, and watched the first-years being sorted below.

She was thirty-five. She was the last Black. She was a soldier, a survivor, a woman who had loved and lost and endured.

Beside her stood Teddy Lupin, eleven years old, his hair changing colors with his nervousness — pink, then purple, then a shy brown. He looked up at Cassie, his eyes his father's eyes.

"Was he brave?" Teddy asked. "My dad."

Cassie looked at the boy — Remus's son, Tonks's son, the child of the war — and she thought of all the nights she had sat with Remus in the dark, holding his hand, telling him he was enough.

"Yes," Cassie said. "He was very brave. And he loved you. More than anything."

Teddy nodded, his hair settling into a steady, calm brown. "Was he in love with you?"

Cassie smiled, and this time the smile reached her eyes. "He was," she said. "For a long time. Across two wars. Across two lifetimes."

"Did you love him back?"

Cassie looked up at the stars — the same stars that had shone on the Astronomy Tower when she was fifteen and afraid and in love. She thought of Regulus in his cave, of Sirius behind the veil, of Remus in the Shrieking Shack with his hand in hers.

"Yes," Cassie said. "I did. I do. I always will."

She took Teddy's hand. "Come on," she said. "Let's go down to the feast. Your grandmother made your favorite."

They walked down the spiral stairs together — Cassie Black, the last of her name, and Teddy Lupin, the future — and beneath them, the castle stood, the stars shone, and the war was over.

Love had not saved them all. But love had remained.

And the stars, ancient and cold and constant, shone down on them both.

The End

Canon Notes:

Cassiopeia Black is an original character. In *Harry Potter* canon, Sirius and Regulus Black are the only children of Orion and Walburga Black; Cassie is the singular divergence from canon.

All other elements are canon-compliant: - Sirius Black ran away from home at sixteen and was disowned; he was later sent to Azkaban without trial (died June 1996, Department of Mysteries). - Regulus Black became a Death Eater, then attempted to destroy a horcrux (Salazar Slytherin's locket) and died in the cave in 1979. - Remus Lupin was a Hogwarts student 1971–1978, a Gryffindor, a prefect, a Marauder ("Moony"), and a werewolf bitten by Fenrir Greyback. He taught Defence Against

the Dark Arts in 1993–94. He joined the reformed Order of the Phoenix in 1995. He married Nymphadora Tonks; their son Teddy Remus Lupin was born April 1998. Remus was killed by Antonin Dolohov at the Battle of Hogwarts, 2 May 1998. - The Battle of Hogwarts took place 2 May 1998; Voldemort was killed the same day. - Grimmauld Place was the ancestral Black family home and served as Order of the Phoenix headquarters (1995–1997).